▼ PROMISES

A SIMPLE WAY TO RAISE BIHAR'S GDP

Tejashwi Yadav may have a degree in quantum mathematics, for all you know. He has put out a grand promise that defies all conventional accounting: one government job to every family of Bihar that does not have anyone in that sector. A noble thought, yes. After all, the Bihar government has only a slim workforce of 2.5 million right now. And in all, only 2.6 million families have anyone with a job in the state or central government or a PSU. A pitiful ratio.



Problem is, Bihar has 27.6 million families. Subtract 2.6 million, and that's 25 million new government jobs. Assuming a basic Rs 39,000 monthly salary for each, as Union minister **Amit Shah** pointed out, that would mean a recurring annual salary bill of Rs 12.17 lakh crore! That's three times Bihar's annual budget of Rs 3.17 lakh crore. Thing is, Tejashwi had created much traction in 2020 by promising 1 million jobs. With Nitish having stolen his thunder, he had to up his ante. Hence, this multibagger stock!



Illustrations by SIDDHANT JUMDE



▼ FAMILY MATTERS

Mere Paas Daadi Hai

Tej Pratap Yadav—the scion who went sideways—retains a bit of dad Lalu's flair for the amusing, albeit minus the armoury. Be that as it may, he decided to steal the limelight in Mahua on October 16, filing his nomination against the Rashtriya Janata Dal's official candidate. He clutched a framed photograph of his grandmother as if to announce, theatrically, that he needn't arrive with a political entourage. A mischievous, cinematic surrogate for the lack of familial backing. A day earlier, younger brother Tejashwi had completed the more orthodox ritual, filing from neighbouring Raghopur. The full family tableau was in attendance: Lalu, Rabri Devi, elder sis Misa. Tej Pratap, expelled from his natal party earlier this year for his erratic ways, had to go solo. Literally. Even so, he seemed to relish the optics, even saying the obvious line aloud: "*Mere paas daadi ka aashirwad hai.*"

—Amitabh Srivastava